

THE WORLD'S LARGEST CLASSROOM

A Proposal for Philanthropic Investment

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The Vision

One building. Thirteen floors. Every surface a screen.

The Chet Holifield Federal Building is a one-million-square-foot stepped pyramid in Southern California. Built in 1971. Vacant since 2025. Nobody knows what to do with it.

We want to wrap it in displays and turn it into the world's most visible educational institution.

Not a building that houses education. A building that IS education.

The Building

The federal government has tried to sell this building three times. Each attempt has failed.

- 2023: Auction with preservation requirements. Zero bids.
- 2024: Auction without preservation. Winner's bid cancelled after lawsuit.
- 2025: Award to runner-up cancelled. New auction announced, then cancelled.

Developers want to tear it down. The hospital wants it for expansion. Preservationists want it frozen in amber. Neighbors want it gone.

Nobody has proposed making it useful.

The Transformation

Every terrace becomes a display surface. LED mesh or modular panels wrapping the building.

The Sphere in Las Vegas cost \$2.3 billion and exists to sell concert tickets. We propose the same technology in service of education.

Dawn: The building illuminates from the bottom up, one terrace at a time.

Morning: The day's lesson appears on the facade. "Good morning, learners."

Day: Visualizations of learning happening worldwide. Real-time data made visible.

Night: Dark mode. Respectful to neighbors. The building sleeps.

The Budget

Capital Requirements

Category	Low	High
Acquisition	\$0	\$50M
Remediation & Systems	\$140M	\$230M
Interior Build-out	\$70M	\$120M
Display Infrastructure	\$190M	\$390M
Site & Contingency	\$141M	\$268M
TOTAL	\$541M	\$1,058M

Working estimate: \$750-800M

Operating Requirements (Annual)

Total annual operating: \$28-42M (working estimate: \$35M/year)

Required endowment at 5% draw: \$200M

Total Capital Campaign

Component	Amount
Capital project	\$750M
Operating endowment	\$200M
TOTAL	\$950M - \$1B

The Ask

We are seeking a lead philanthropic commitment of **\$100-150M** to:

1. Demonstrate financial credibility to GSA
2. Anchor the capital campaign
3. Enable serious negotiation for the property

Impact Metrics

Metric	Year 3	Year 5	Year 10
Daily active learners	100K	1M	5M
Lessons delivered annually	36M	365M	1.8B
School field trips hosted	200	500	1,000
Countries reached	50	100	150

Timeline

Milestone	Target
Lead commitment	Q2 2026
GSA negotiation complete	Q3 2026
Property acquisition	Q4 2026
Remediation complete	Q4 2027
Display installation	Q4 2028
Grand opening	Q1 2029

The Case for Investment

Education is usually invisible. It happens behind walls, in classrooms, on screens no one else sees.

This project makes education visible at architectural scale. It says: learning matters enough to put on a building.

Why now: The building is available. After three failed attempts to sell it, GSA is exhausted. A credible educational buyer with committed capital could acquire this property within 12-18 months.

Why us: Nicolette Rankin has 20 years of experience scaling educational products to millions of users. Lesson of the Day is already building the content and technology. What we lack is the physical presence — the monument — that makes the mission undeniable.

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A building that teaches by being seen.